

Dramatic Dialogue – Presented by Maloney Lalavanua & Frances Veikoso

Title: For Such a Time As this

Author: Esther, Chapters 3- 5

A quiet corner of the palace, Esther is pacing. Mordecai enters urgently.

Mordecai: Esther! I have been trying to get word to you all day.

Esther: Mordecai? You shouldn't be here like this. If someone sees you—

Mordecai: This is more important than palace rules. Something terrible has happened.

Esther: *(Concerned)* What is it?

Mordecai: Haman has convinced the king to sign a decree. On a single day, all our people
are to be destroyed.

(Pause. Esther goes still.)

Esther: All... our people?

Mordecai: Yes.

Esther: Does the king know I am one of them?

Mordecai: No. But he must know. You must tell him.

Esther: *(Shaken)* I cannot just walk into the throne room. You know the law. If anyone
approaches the king without being summoned... they could be killed.

Mordecai: Unless he extends the golden sceptre.

Esther: And if he doesn't?

(Silence.)

Mordecai: Esther... do not think that because you are in the palace you will escape this.

Esther: I know that!

Mordecai: If you remain silent, help may come from somewhere else. But you... you will have missed your moment.

(Esther looks away, struggling.)

Esther: You make it sound so simple.

Mordecai: It is not simple. It is dangerous.

Esther: I am afraid, Mordecai.

Mordecai: I know.

Esther: Every day I try to be the perfect queen. I wear the right clothes. I say the right words. I smile at the right time. But this... this is different.

Mordecai: Because this is about who you really are.

(Pause.)

Mordecai (gently): Who knows, Esther... whether you have come to your royal position for such a time as this?

(Long pause. Esther breathes deeply.)

Esther: For such a time as this...

Mordecai: Perhaps you are here not just to wear a crown --- but to make a difference.

Esther: If I go to the king, I could lose everything.

Mordecai: And if you do not go, others will lose everything.

(Esther straightens slowly.)

Esther: Then this not about me.

(She takes a steady breath.)

Esther: Gather our people. Tell them to fast and pray for three days. I will do the same.

Mordecai: And then?

Esther: Then I will go to the king.

Mordecai: Even if he hasn't called for you?

Esther: Yes.

(Small pause.)

Esther (quiet but strong): and if I perish, I perish.

(Mordecai looks at her with pride.)

Mordecai: You are braver than you know.

Esther: No. I am still afraid.

Mordecai: Courage is not the absence of fear, Esther. It is choosing to do what is right
despite it.

(Esther nods.)

Esther: Then I choose courage.

(She lifts her head.)

Esther: For my people. For what is right. For such a time as this.

(They stand together in quiet strength. Lights fade.)